

RE-RETRO!

WITH THE RESURGENCE OF RETRO TECH AND ITS REINVIGORATED POPULARITY, WE ARE, IN A SENSE HEADING 'BACK' TO THE FUTURE

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Technology has taken blazing strides over the past decade or so, however, nostalgia is a powerful force that inadvertently causes businesses and companies to reel their flashy, new tech in and return to simpler times. Retro-chic is an actual term which in the modern day equates to “the fashionableness of the nostalgic revival of a style”.

In 2017, we saw the return of “Jurassic Tech”, which was dubbed aptly since this was the year retro really reclaimed its footing in the tech space, especially with the revival of the legendary Nokia 3310. In 2016, vinyl sales peaked at a 25-year high as consumers around the world, young and old, embraced the archaic formats of music again. Many such instances have proven that even though old tech is made obsolete by newer tech, they can be revived and carved out their own market, based on nostalgia alone!

RE-TECH? THE STUFF THAT'S ALREADY BACK

Let's take a look at the retro tech products that have made a comeback in the past few years.

Gaming consoles

All of us fondly remember the first console we held in our hands. Hours of our childhood was spent glued to these devices, and they're back! The rebooted versions are sure to give you a shot of nostalgia, and will do it with modern connectors, and fewer cables, all while keeping the original aesthetic that you loved.

Nintendo, for example, revived the classic NES and SNES in miniaturised versions that gained immense popularity, very quickly. They provided a large library of games while emulating the original retro consoles. Another retro console that got a reboot is the C64 (Commodore 64), which was immensely popular in the 8-Bit era, and was in a bitter rivalry with the Nintendo consoles. The C64 Mini is a recreation of the original Commodore, coming with a



NES (Super Nintendo Entertainment System) Classic Mini was released in September, 2017

joystick, just like the original did, which elicits waves of nostalgic goodness! Plus, you get access to 64 classic games with the C64 (that was expected, wasn't it?).

Another console to make a much-awaited comeback was the Sega Genesis Mini which grants gamers access to 40 old, legendary titles such as Sonic the Hedgehog, ToeJam and Earl and more. Before the Mini, the Sega Genesis Flashback series was released in 2017 by AtGames, who are the same makers that created yet another retro console, the Atari Flashback series. Sony also decided to join the retro console train with the revival of the original PlayStation (a min-

iature version) in December 2018 which brought back 20 original games, 25 years after its initial release. The console also comes with two classic PS1 controllers.

Vinyl and turntables

Music is swiftly returning to its old-tech roots with vinyl and turntables making an impressive comeback in the past few years. While this is confounding to some, the numbers speak for themselves, with vinyl record sales having risen a gargantuan 260 per cent from 2009 to 2015, according to a 2015 Nielsen report. Pulling an LP out of its sleeve, hearing the subtle needle scratch and enjoying the warm melody emitting from the record player is some sort of inexplicable magic which cannot be replicated by simply pressing play on a phone. Plus, improvements in the tech mean that the modern vinyl listening experience is far superior to the old days, with better hardware available.

Modern-day turntables are very popular, with both vinyl LPs and turntables occupying a niche but prominent space in the music scene today. Many modern turntables come with a USB port, which allows you to digitise your music, and get that authentic turntable sound in digital format as well. The Technics SL-1200G made a comeback in 2016, with Panasonic hoping to cash in on the retro wave by rebooting its classic turntable.

Typewriters

Manual typewriters were considered an overly complicated technology when they replaced the fountain pen back in the 1800s. Electric typewriters took their